Application guide

Advanced Research in Telecommunications Systems (ARTES) Call in Spain

ARTES Spanish National Call 2024

December 2024

AGENCIA ESPACIAL ESPAÑOLA

esa

ARTES Call in Spain

In this document, you will find information about the Spanish Space Technology Call 2024 to obtain support from the Spanish Space Agency for funding proposals targeting the ESA Call for Proposal 4-40017/24/NL/GM ARTES 4.0 Technologies and Products for C&G, Optical and Quantum Communication – ScyLight-, Space Systems for Safety and Security (4S) and 5G/6G and Sustainable Connectivity.

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1. What can I apply for?

In the ARTES Spanish National Call 2024, the Agencia Espacial Española (hereafter: AEE) has allocated up to 22.4 M€ to support Spanish entities' (companies and research institutions) Satellite Communications (Satcom)-related activities.

The purpose of the call is to build and expand Satcom technology capabilities in Spain and strengthen the competitiveness of the Spanish industry in the European and global satcom market.

The call is targeting proposals for the definition (only for the Strategic Programme Lines), development, verification, and demonstration (only for the Strategic Programme Lines), of products for the Satcom market, with the objective of future commercial exploitation of the products. An eligible product may be any hardware, software, system or sub-system, or may consist in a service.

It is not a requirement that the activity cover all phases of a project. However, funding for additional phases through a CCN cannot be guaranteed at this time and will be subject to a new call.

The proposed work shall not overlap with any previous or presently running ESA or National activities awarded to any entity in the Proposed Team.

In 2024, the Call is divided into four categories (programme lines):

- **Category 1: "ARTES C&G" Generic Programme Line,** dedicated to telecom systems (e.g. end-to-end satcom systems, network protocols, propagation, resource management, air interfaces); telecom satellite platforms (e.g. attitude & orbit control, mechanical, thermal, power and propulsion techniques, devices, equipment and systems); telecom satellite payloads (e.g. antenna, repeater, and signal processing techniques, devices, equipment and systems); and ground segment of telecommunication systems (e.g. satellite user terminals, gateway, network, operations and mission control techniques, devices, equipment and systems).

  A maximum budget of 5,8 M€ will be allocated by AEE to this category.

- **Category 2: "Optical and Quantum Communications Strategic (ScyLight)" Programme Line**, dedicated to demonstration and development of optical communication, photonics and quantum communication technologies enabling optical networks connecting multi-orbit satellites with ground optical networks, as well as quantum satellite connectivity for applications such as QKD and entanglement distribution over long distance.

  A maximum budget of 5,5 M€ will be allocated by AEE to this category.

- **Category 3: "Space Systems for Safety and Security (4S)" Strategic Programme Line,** dedicated to supporting European satellite operators, service providers and the manufacturing industry, in ensuring new levels of security, robustness and resilience, which will become the standard for space communication solutions around the world. It

also aims to support the development of future satellite communications-based, end-to-end safety and security applications for sectors such as maritime and aeronautical.

A maximum budget of 9,5 M€ will be allocated by AEE to this category, SAGA-related activities being explicitly excluded.

- **Category 4: "Space for 5G/6G" Strategic Programme Line,** dedicated to supporting European satellite operators, mobile network operators, as well as industry and academia, in the field of 5th and 6th generation of communication networks (5G/6G), given the unique opportunities of orchestration and seamless integration of satellite with terrestrial networks (mobile, fixed, wireless) as an integral part of 5G and future 6G systems.

A maximum budget of 1,6 M€ will be allocated by AEE to this category.

Read more about ESA's ARTES programme here.

If in one of the four categories the ESA budget is not fully allocated, the remaining budget could be allocated in any of the other categories, at the discretion of AEE.

Note: On 20th November 2024, an information session was hosted by AEE.

https://www.aee.gob.es/Convocatorias/2024/ARTES_NAVISPE2.html

2. Who can apply?

To apply for funding from the ARTES Spanish Space Technology Call 2024, applicants must meet the following eligibility requirements:

- The applying entity (company or institution) must be registered in Spain, and the work must be carried out in Spain.
- In case the proposal foresees the participation of subcontractors, the support of the Spanish Space Agency will be limited to the Spanish part of the work. Any work to be carried out by non-Spanish sub-contractors must be self-funded by the latter or authorised and funded by their respective member states.

In addition, the applying entity shall comply with the Special Conditions for the submission of the Outline Proposal (see section 5).

Applicants should be registered in **esa-star** for the last steps of the application process. It is highly encouraged to do this early. If the applicant is not already registered in esa-star, please use the following link: https://www.esa.int/About_Us/Business_with_ESA/How_to_do/esa-star_registration_process

3. Timeline and planning

ARTES Call in Spain timeline and planning.

Date	Description	Who
20th November 2024	ARTES Call Information Session	ESA / AEE / Entities
2nd December 2024	Application guide published in website	AEE
2nd December 2024	**Launch of the ARTES Call in Spain**	
10th February 2025 23:59 CET	**Deadline for Submission of Outline Proposal**	**Entities**
April 2025	Publication of the pre-selected activity list on the AEE website.	AEE
April 2025	Official ESA- Request for Full Proposal (RFP)	ESA
April 2025	Technical discussion meetings (teleconference)	ESA (Organiser) / Pre-selected Entities
June 2025	**Indicative deadline for Submission of Full Proposal in esa-star, to be confirmed in Letter of Support**	**Entities**
September 2025	Negotiation meetings	ESA/Entities
Q4 2025	**Kick-off**	**ESA/Entities**

(The timeline might be subject to changes depending, in particular on the number of proposals received and subject to evaluation and the duration of the technical discussions after the preselection.)

4. ARTES Development Phases target of this National Call

The work proposed through this National Call can include one or more of the ARTES Development Phases listed hereunder, with the indicated restrictions depending on the corresponding Programme Line.

(1) The **Definition Phase**, in which industry is supported in the initial definition and top-level product design through technical studies. The objective of this phase is to produce a Requirements System Analysis. This Phase can only be used in any of the 3 Strategic Programme Lines under this Call.

(2) The **Technology Phase**, in which the mitigation of technical risks is supported. The objective of this phase is to produce a breadboard, a prototype or an engineering model. This phase excludes qualification of space equipment and industrialization of ground equipment.

(3) The **Product Phase**, in which the development, qualification, verification, and industrialization of the product is supported. The objective of this phase is to make the product ready for commercialization in its intended operational environment.

(4) The **Demonstration Phase**, in which flight heritage and demonstration for space products, and the validation of ground segment products in the operational environment, is supported. The objective of this phase is to validate the product in its operational environment. This Phase can only be used in any of the 3 Strategic Programme Lines under this Call.

Through these four phases, the complete product development cycle is incorporated. A proposal can be aimed at any one or more of these phases. Starting the proposed work at the Definition Phase is not a requirement.

5. Conditions and the Process

How much can I apply for?

For this Call, the Spanish Space Agency will provide support to the selected proposals within the funding limits, and price brackets shown below. They depend on the Programme Line. In this National Call, the definition and demonstration phases are only available for activities corresponding to the Strategic Programme Lines (SPL).

Development Phase	Funding level up to		
	Non-SME	SME	Universities or Research Institutes with no commercial interest in the product
Definition Phase (only for SPL)	50%	50%	50% of max 30% of phase price
Technology Phase	50%	50%	50% of max 30% of phase price
Product Phase	50%	50%	50% of max 30% of phase price
Demonstration Phase (only for SPL)	50%	50%	50% of max 30% of phase price

Programme Line	Total allocated budget by AEE	Minimum and Maximum ESA prices per contract
ARTES C&G Generic Programme Line	5.8 M€	300 K€ - 2.5 M€
ScyLight SPL	5.5 M€	300 K€ - 2 M€
4S SPL	9.5 M€	300 K€ - 2 M€
5G/6G SPL	1.6 M€	300 K€ - 800 K€

The maximum duration of the proposed activities is 36 months.

How do I apply?

The application process for an ARTES activity is as follows:

- **Step 1:** Ensure you're registered in esa-star.
- **Step 2:** Submit an Outline Proposal through the Open Space Innovation Platform (OSIP) campaign dedicated to the Spanish ARTES Call **before the closing date.**
- **Step 3:** AEE, with the support of ESA, evaluates the received Outline Proposals and pre-selects the activities to be supported. The list of selected outline proposals will be published in the AEE´s web site.
- **Step 4:** Successful applicants will receive a Letter of Support from the AEE for their activities and will be invited by ESA to submit a Full Proposal to ESA through esa-star.

Step 1: Ensure you're registered in esa-star

Please note that a pre-requisite for submitting any technology development proposal to ARTES, is to have completed the on-line dedicated questionnaire for being registered in esa-

star as an entity wishing to do business with ESA.

"esa-star registration" website:
https://esastar-emr.sso.esa.int/

esa-star Registration User Manual:
https://esastar-emr.sso.esa.int/Account/DownloadFile

Please note that only the "Full Registration" allows a Contract to be placed with the selected Tenderer after a successful negotiation of a positively evaluated full proposal by ESA. It is therefore recommended to start this registration process promptly.

Step 2: Submit an Outline Proposal to ARTES in OSIP

The deadline for submitting an Outline Proposal to ESA is **10th February 2025.**

On ESA's ARTES website, you can download the **outline proposal template** and the **financial forecast workbook** for a co-funded activity. Please note that the instructions in this document supersede the instructions in the channels in OSIP.

Applicants must apply through the selected application process, where a company/institution submits its activity proposal. The application is called **Outline Proposal**.
To submit your Outline Proposal, click *"Submit Your Idea"* at the top of the ARTES Campaign webpage.

Special Conditions for the submission of the Outline Proposal:

- For all Call Categories, the additional requested documents indicated in the *Annex 1 - Additional requested documents* of this guidelines shall be submitted in the corresponding channel together with the Outline Proposal, preferably in one single separate pdf.
- For all Call Categories an additional sub-chapter addressing the Impact for the Spanish Space Sector shall be included in the outline proposal following the guidelines in the *Annex 2*.
- For all Call Categories, a cost breakdown shall be provided in the outline. **Any** expected expenditures (regardless of the amount) outside Spain shall also be listed, together with any expenditures in external major services (those above 10K€).

Step 3: Outline Proposals Evaluation

After the deadline for submitting Outline Proposals, the evaluation and selection is conducted by AEE with the support of ESA. The final decision is made based on the process described in this document. Evaluation criteria can be found in the Annex 3.

AEE will publish the list of selected proposals in the AEE web site. For the selected proposals, recommendations for improvement may be provided and shall be considered in the preparation of the full proposal.

AEE will submit Letters of support to ESA for the selected applicants.

After the provision of Letters of Support, the AEE is no longer involved in the application process and contract negotiation.

Step 4: Submit Full Proposal to ESA

Applicant entities that submitted ARTES Outline Proposals that have been positively evaluated will receive an invitation from ESA to submit a Full Proposal following the ESA Star process.

The Full proposal builds on the outline proposal taking into consideration the previous recommendations.

In the event of a successful evaluation of the Full Proposal, ESA and the applicant engage in negotiations to finalize a contract.

6. Agencia Espacial Española (AEE): Contact Information

The ARTES Spanish National Call 2024 is managed by the Spanish Space Agency (AEE) with the advice of the European Space Agency (ESA).

If you have any questions concerning the call, you are welcome to contact the AEE for clarification. Potential applicants who have no previous experience with the application process at ESA are encouraged to contact the AEE for guidance.

Please contact **artes2024@aee.gob.es** if you need advice.

7. Annex 1: Additional requested documents

Documents requested in this Annex 1 can be provided in Spanish.

Applicant entities are requested to provide the following, in an **Annex** included in the Outline Proposal:

- The signed subcontracts or cooperation agreements or letters confirming the terms of the cooperation with the consortium members or subcontractors.

- Any existing documentation showing reliably an interest of future customers or collaborations either for acquiring / exploiting the developed technologies or for exploiting scientifically the outputs of the project.

In addition, applicants are requested to submit a **Certified Statement** for the main proposer and each consortium member who would directly receive funding if this activity, justifying that:

- The entities have not filed for bankruptcy and have not been declared insolvent

- Are up to date with payments and comply with obligations regarding Taxes and Social Security, as imposed by current Spanish Regulations

- Are not in situation of delinquency with respect the Spanish Administration and ESA

- Are not already receiving public funding for the development tasks object of the present proposal.

The information requested as a certified statement shall be uploaded on the corresponding OSIP channel under the heading *"Certified statements*".

8. Annex 3: Detailed Assessment Criteria

1. **Credibility of Business Plan (*to be assessed by ESA*):**
    - Credibility of the business opportunity in the market context, including sustainability in the commercial market without further institutional support.
    - Improvement of global competitiveness of Europe in Satcom commercial markets;
2. **Quality and completeness of the product definition and technical implementation (*to be assessed by ESA*):**
    - Product definition and development plan;
    - Evaluation of technical risks and credibility of the risk mitigation actions;
    - Verification and validation approach.
3. **Adequacy of the implementation approach (*to be assessed by ESA*):**
    - List of hardware and software deliverables;
    - Schedule;
    - Adequacy of available funding for the activity objectives and phases;
    - Adequacy of the overall product development roadmap and expected funding
4. **Adequacy of the bidding consortium (*to be assessed by ESA*):**
    - Completeness of the proposed consortium;
    - Company/ies technical and commercial relevant experience in all areas of the proposed activities;
    - Adequacy of the company resources with respect to the requested funding
5. **Spanish National Call specific criteria (*to be assessed by AEE*):**
    - Return on investment for Spain: financial return to the Spanish space sector should be strongly demonstrated, including for the lead applicant, their partners and supply chains, and for the overall Spanish Space Ecosystem;
    - Potential of the proposal to grant Spain a leadership role in missions or in the development of payloads.
    - Leverage of the Spanish industry competitiveness, and the increase of market options of Spain in the international arena;
    - Feasibility of the proposal and programmatic risk;

- Consistency of the proposal with the strategic plan or goals of the company;
- Mission context and relevance for the Spanish Space policy objectives: programme context, international partners, etc.;
- Continuity from previously funded activities (if applicable).

Projects that receive an assessment lower than 40/100 in any of the criteria above, will NOT be considered by the national delegation for a letter of support.